BRITTANY ALMQUIST LEWIS

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Olin School of Business, Washington Univ. St. Louis, *Assistant Prof. of Finance*	2022 – present
Guthrie Center for Real Estate, Northwestern University, *Visiting Scholar*	2020 – 2025
Kelley School of Business, Indiana University, *Visiting Associate Researcher*	2022 – 2023
Kelley School of Business, Indiana University, *Assistant Prof. of Finance*	2020 – 2022

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, *Dissertation Fellow*	Jul. – Nov. 2018
Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco Thomas J. Sargent, *Dissertation Fellow*	Jun. – Jul. 2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Financial Intermediation, Household Finance, Real Estate

EDUCATION

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, Ph.D. Finance, 2020
Dissertation: "Essays on Financial Intermediation"
Committee: Dimitris Papanikolaou, Lawrence Christiano, Janice Eberly, John Mondragon
Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, M.S. Finance, 2020
Boston College, B.A. Finance (cum laude), 2010
Boston College, B.A. Information Systems (cum laude), 2010

PUBLICATIONS

1**. Lewis, Brittany**, 2023, **"Creditor Rights, Collateral Reuse, and Credit Supply**," ***Journal of Financial Economics (2023)*** 149, 451-472 (previously titled: *The Effect of Dealer Leverage on Mortgage Quality)*

- Online Appendix • Replication Package • AEA 2022 Poster
- Press: Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance • The Olin Blog • Kelley School of Business News

2. **Lewis, Brittany**, 2025, **"Bank Leverage Restrictions in General Equilibrium: Solving for Sectoral Value Functions,"** ***Journal of Risk and Financial Management*** - *Special Issue:* ***Financial Resilience in Turbulent Times (2025)*** *18*(9), 519

- Press: Olin Business, Professors on Point (PoP) Video Series, WashU Olin Business Insights

3. Hamdi, Naser, Jiang, Erica, **Lewis, Brittany**, Padi, Manisha, and Pal, Avantika, 2026, **"The Rise of Nonbanks in Servicing Household Debt,"** ***(Forthcoming Journal of Finance)***

- Winning NBER grant proposal, "Shadow Banks and Financial Distress in Minority Communities: The Debt Servicing Channel," Co-PI with Erica Jiang and Manisha Padi

- Press: The FinReg Blog Sponsored by Duke Financial Economics Center, AEA 2025 Video Series, Olin CFAR Top Cited Paper of 2024

WORKING PAPERS

4**. Lewis, Brittany**, Padi, Manisha, 2025, **"Regulating Secondary Loan Markets: Evidence from Small Business Lending"** ***(Resubmitted 2nd Round to Journal of Financial Economics)***

Pools of securitized loans must satisfy pooling criteria to be sold in secondary markets. We show that tighter criteria increase lenders' cost of capital, which shifts loan characteristics and reallocates credit access away from harder-to-pool loans, yielding real economic impacts. Utilizing novel government-backed small business loan data, we study impacts of tightening criteria governing maturities, using instrumented difference-in-differences. We show that reform decreases secondary market prices, delays pool formation, and drives primary market shifts towards shorter maturity, streamlined loans, with lower defaults. Access to capital drops for industries needing long-term physical-asset-backed loans, resulting in less economic activity in treated counties.

5**. Lewis, Brittany**, Padi, Manisha, Wang, Xiyu, Wang, Zhongyu 2025, **"The Cost of Servicing Debt Pools"**

Mortgage servicers face highly variable costs and depend on servicing fees for compensation. We demonstrate that the majority of servicing fees are uniform across securitized loan pools, consistent with average cost pricing. We calculate a risk based break-even servicing fee for each loan and document significant mispricing, which potentially distorts servicers' foreclosure incentives. Utilizing quasi-random assignment of loans to pools, we establish that higher mispricing increases borrower foreclosure rates and decreases investor returns, with more severe distortions in heterogeneous pools. A theoretical welfare framework comparing uniform versus variable fee regimes shows that investor losses are small relative to borrower losses.

6**. Lewis, Brittany**, 2022, **"The Impact of Warehouse Collateral Value on Mortgage Originations"**

- Winning proposal: IU Racial Justice Research Fund Grant "Racial Inequality in the Housing Market"
- Press: Wells Fargo Advisors CFAR "See Far" Magazine *(Featured Article),* WashU Expert
- March 13, 2026 Executive Order - Critique Requested by Senator Warren's Banking Committee

I study how, when the borrower is a financial intermediary, increasing collateral value — by strengthening creditor rights on collateral backing warehouse funding — spurs downstream lending product innovation, stimulating credit demand, and longer-term effects. Exploiting BAPCPA 2005 causally isolates increased collateral value's effect on downstream lending innovation. More exposed regions receive increased alternative mortgages with lower documentation and initial-payment-to-balance ratios, crowding out government mortgages and expanding, then contracting, mortgage demand. More exposed regions experience increased payment shocks on resetting mortgages, degraded loan performance, amplified home price cycles, and adverse labor market outcomes — especially among minority borrowers.

7. Dalgic, Husnu, **Lewis, Brittany**, Modena, Andrea, 2026 **"Pledgeable Collateral, Dealer Leverage, and Runs"**

We show that strengthening creditor rights in the sale and repurchase (repo) market can exacerbate financial instability, particularly under short debt maturities and low collateral volatility. We build a model of financial intermediaries that raise financing by pledging collateral in the repo market. In the short term, increasing collateral pledgeability makes repo creditors safer and reduces debt rollover risk; however, it also expands

long-term debt capacity and leverage, ultimately heightening run risk. This instability is a distinct feature of environments with long-term liabilities and low volatility assets, where market discipline fails to constrain post-policy leverage. We test our model's predictions by exploiting the 2005 BAPCPA bankruptcy reform, which expanded creditor protections via repo safe harbors. Using hand-collected data on dealer repo collateral, we confirm that while the law enhanced collateral pledgeability, it fueled short-term leverage and precipitated sharper de-leveraging during the downturn.

SEMINARS & CONFERENCES

Seminars (including scheduled), ∗presented by co-author, +postponed due to COVID

2026: CU-Boulder (Leeds) • UCSD (Rady) • BYU • Utah (Eccles) • University of Houston (Bauer) • Ellington Wealth Management • Berkeley-Law* • Federal Reserve Board*

2025: Goethe & SAFE • University Carlos III de Madrid • Junior Household Finance Seminar (UVA, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) • Michigan (Ross) • Australian National University • Berkeley Law* • University of Toronto (Law)* • ETH Zurich (Law & Econ)* • University of Zurich (Law & Econ)* • NY Fed* • UNC Charlotte*

2024: CFAR Fall Board Meeting • UNSW • University of Sydney • University of Melbourne • Yale Law* • U Chicago Law* • Columbia Law* • Cornell*

2023: CU-Boulder Leeds • UT Austin (McCombs) • Washington University in St. Louis • Federal Reserve Board* • UT-Austin Law* • UT-Dallas Law* • Treasury* • USC – Marshall*

2022: Federal Reserve Bank of New York

2021: Junior Household Finance Seminar (UVA, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) • University of Oregon (Lundquist) • IU Summer Health Policy Workshop • Stanford GSB • Washington University in St. Louis (Olin)

2020: Emory (Goizueta) • Federal Reserve Bank of New York • University of Georgia (Terry) • University of Delaware (Lerner) • University of Wisconsin-Madison • Federal Reserve Board of Governors • Johns Hopkins (Carey) • Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond • Federal Reserve Bank of Boston • London Business School • Bank for International Settlements • Indiana University (Kelley) • Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas • University of Melbourne+ • Monash University+ • Junior Household Finance Seminar (UVA, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) • Northwestern Department of Economics

2019: Wisconsin School of Business at UW Madison • Kellogg School of Management Strategy Department • Northwestern Department of Economics

2018: Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco • Federal Reserve Board of Governors Division of Financial Stability

2008: Boston College Undergraduate Research Symposium, ***Awarded Best Presentation***

Conference Presentations (including scheduled), ∗presented by co-author, ^poster

2027: AEA

2026: WashU Olin Business and University of Gothenburg Joint Conference • ALEA • AREUEA • Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance (EIEF) 8th Rome Junior Finance Conference • ECWFC • 20th Annual Conference on Empirical Legal Studies (CELS)* • 3rd Texas A&M University Law & Economics Conference*

2025: AEA^ • SFS Cavalcade • EFA • ALEA*

2024: CEPR Household Finance Conference • UW Fostering Inclusion Workshop • BIS-CEPR-SCG-SFI Conference on Financial Intermediation^ • Philadelphia Fed Mortgage Market Research Conference^ • EFMA • Early Career Women in Finance Conference (ECWFC) • Australian National University Banking and Financial Stability Meeting joint with Financial Research Network FIRN

2023: AFA AFFECT Workshop • Chicago Booth Empirical Finance Conference • SAET • Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) • Red Rock* • INFORMS Annual Meeting • Junior Finance Conference, UW-Madison* • Fischer Shain Research Conference* • Census Bureau Workshop on Race, Ethnicity, and Inequality

2022: AEA • AEA • Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • WFA • Olin-St. Louis Federal Reserve Mini-Conference

2021: Eastern Economic Association (EEA) • Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • Midwest Finance Association (MFA) • Oxford Saïd - ETH Zurich Macro-finance Conference

DISCUSSIONS *(including scheduled)*

2026: AFA

2025: MFA

2024: AEA • AFA IBEFA • Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • Midwest Finance Association (MFA) • BIS-CEPR-SCG-SFI Conference on Financial Intermediation • Western Finance Association (WFA) x2 • EFA

2023: Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • SFS Cavalcade • NBER Summer Institute (Household Finance) • University of Oregon Summer Finance Conference

2022: Midwest Finance Association (MFA) • Craig Holden Memorial Conference

2021: 5th Annual Yale Junior Finance Conference • Western Economic Association (WEA) • Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting (CFEA)

2020: Midwest Finance Association (MFA)

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Awards:

Eastern Finance Association Rising Scholar	2024

Fellowships:

AFFECT Grant in support of ECWFC 2025 ($5,000, Co-PI)	2025
Household Finance Grant, NBER ($15,000, Co-PI)	2022 – 2023
Research Equipment Fund Grant, Indiana University ($75,000, PI)	2021

Kelley Research Funding Grant, Kelley School of Business ($24,500, PI)	2021
Kelley Research Funding Grant, Kelley School of Business ($15,000, Co-PI)	2021
Racial Justice Research Fund, Indiana University ($15,000, PI)	2020 – 2021
Kellogg Research Funding Grant, Northwestern University ($3,000, PI)	2019
Kellogg School of Management Fellowship, Northwestern University	2014 – 2019
MFS - 10th Macro Finance Society Workshop Ph.D. Award (Link)	2017
Henrietta Grigg-Lewis Foundation Scholarship	2006 – 2009
Boston College Advanced Study Grant, Awarded Best Presentation	2007
Western New York Academic Scholarship	2006 – 2007

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Refereeing:
Journal of Finance, Journal of Financial Economics, Journal of Financial Intermediation, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Journal of Financial Services Research, Journal of Monetary Economics, Management Science, Real Estate Economics, Review of Corporate Finance Studies, Review of Financial Studies

Service to the Profession:
2026 Koch Center Faculty Affiliate
2026 22nd Annual Olin Finance Conference at WashU Organizer
2025 20th Early Career Women in Finance Conference (ECWFC) Organizer
2025 WFA Program Committee
2024 WFA Program Committee; Session Chair co-chaired w/ Emily Williams *HBS*
2023 EFA Session Chair co-chaired w/ Arkodipta Sarkar *NUS*
2020 SFS Cavalcade North America Faculty Host - First Virtual Conference
2020 Federal Reserve Board Mentoring to Interns

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Washington University – St. Louis

FIN 4601/5601: Research Methods in Finance (MSFQ, Undergraduate) — Fall 2022 – present
- Previously numbered FIN 470A/560A

FIN 3150: Capital Markets and Financial Management (Undergraduate) — Fall 2025 – present

Indiana University

F300: Introduction to Financial Management (Undergraduate) — Fall 2020 – Fall 2021

Northwestern University (teaching assistant)

FINC 470: International Finance (MBA and Executive MBA) — Fall 2015 – Fall 2017
Professor Sergio Rebelo

FINC 941: Macroeconomic Policy and Global Capital Markets (MBA) — Winter 2016 – Spring 2017
Professor Janice Eberly
Professor Nicolas Crouzet

Boston College (teaching assistant)

ISYS0021: Computers in Management (Undergraduate) — Fall 2007 – Fall 2008
Professor Gerald Kane

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Professor Brian Weller, Kellogg School of Management Jul. – Aug. 2015
Research Assistant to Professor Gerald C. Kane, Boston College Mar. 2007 – May 2008

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Analysis Group, Summer Analyst Intern (2008)/Analyst/Sr. Analyst, Boston, MA Aug. 2010 – Jun. 2014
Pioneer Investments, Equity Research Summer Analyst, Singapore Aug. – Sep. 2009
KPMG, Information Technology (IT) Advisory Summer Analyst , New York City, NY Jun. – Jul. 2009

OTHER ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE

Outreach:
Public Service Economics, Boston 2010-2013
Dress for Success – Database Manager, Boston 2008-2009

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: USA

SKILLS

Language: English (native), Spanish (advanced)
Computer: SAS, STATA, R, SQL, Matlab, Fortran, Python, Command Line Scripting, HTML, PHP, LiveCode, Socialtext Wiki, LaTeX

STUDENT PLACEMENTS

PhD Students
Weiting Hu – University of Queensland (2023)

Master's Students
Joey (Zhongyu) Wang – Univ. of Rochester Simon Finance (PhD 2025)
Kara (Jiaye) Wei – Chubb Insurance - Workforce Management Manager (2025)
Snow Feng – Fuyao Glass Corp - Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) Analyst (2025)
Xiaoling Wu – UC Boulder Leeds Finance (PhD 2024)
Kaihong Luo – CUHK (Pre-doc 2023)